

Checklist

Starter Kit Template

Repository Setup

- Set up the `starter-kits` repository structure
- Create the backend-service template directory
- Create the skeleton directory
- Add all required starter files

Template Files

- Add `Dockerfile`
- Add CI/CD workflow
- Add `package.json`
- Add `README.md`
- Add required source/configuration files
- Add `platformMetadata` to `package.json`
- Record the template name and version for upgrade tracking

Backstage Template

- Create `template.yaml`
- Define service information parameters
- Define team/owner selection
- Define database options
- Define service port
- Define repository location
- Add template-fetching steps
- Add conditional database configuration
- Add infrastructure-claim generation
- Add GitHub publishing step
- Add Kubernetes namespace creation
- Add Backstage catalog registration

- Configure useful output links and next steps

Testing

- Validate the template structure
- Verify required metadata exists
- Verify required skeleton files exist
- Generate a test project
- Run dependency installation
- Run the project build
- Run unit tests
- Run linting
- Verify the application starts successfully
- Verify the `/health` endpoint responds
- Fix all failures before publishing

Publish to Backstage

- Configure `BACKSTAGE_URL`
- Configure `BACKSTAGE_TOKEN`
- Configure required GitHub repository variables
- Run the template publishing script
- Confirm template validation succeeds
- Confirm the template is registered in the Backstage catalog
- Confirm the template appears in the portal

Create a Service

- Open the Backstage **Create** page
- Select **Backend Service**
- Enter the service name
- Select the owning team
- Add a service description
- Select the required database
- Choose the repository location
- Run the scaffolder
- Confirm the GitHub repository is created
- Confirm the Kubernetes namespace is created
- Confirm the service is registered in the catalog

Validate the Generated Service

- Clone the generated repository
- Install dependencies
- Build the service locally
- Run tests locally
- Run linting locally
- Verify the Docker/container build succeeds
- Verify the infrastructure claim exists
- Verify the catalog metadata is valid
- Start the local development environment
- Confirm local development works

Final Verification

- Deploy the service to the platform cluster
- Push a code change
- Observe the CI/CD pipeline execute
- Confirm the pipeline completes successfully
- Verify the service appears in the Backstage catalog
- Confirm the full workflow works from template creation through deployment